

The November general election features two headline candidate races on Lehigh County ballots: a toss-up contest for **U.S. House District 7** and the statewide election for **Governor of Pennsylvania**.

Pennsylvania's 7th Congressional District (PA-07)

PA-07 encompasses all of Lehigh, Northampton, and Carbon counties, along with part of Monroe County. Major nonpartisan rating groups classify this seat as a national **toss-up district** that could help determine party control of the U.S. House.

Candidates

- **Ryan Mackenzie (Republican — Incumbent):** U.S. Representative and former state representative. His platform focuses on conservative economic policies, federal tax relief, border security, deregulation, and supporting local manufacturing.
- **Bob Brooks (Democrat — Challenger):** President of the Pennsylvania Professional Fire Fighters Association, veteran City of Bethlehem firefighter, and small business owner. Endorsed by major labor unions, his platform centers on lowering everyday expenses (housing, healthcare, utilities), expanding worker protections, and preserving social safety net programs.

Key Issues

- **Cost of Living:** Both candidates rank inflation and household expenses as top priorities, with Mackenzie emphasizing spending cuts and deregulation and Brooks pushing for worker wage protections and healthcare affordability.
- **Labor & Jobs:** A major focal point for the Lehigh Valley's large base of union and manufacturing workers.
- **Federal Spending & Social Issues:** Contrasting positions on federal budget priorities, entitlement protection, and federal reproductive rights legislation.

Pennsylvania Governor's Race

This statewide election determines who holds executive authority over state agencies, budget proposals, and legislative veto power for the next four-year term.

Candidates

- **Josh Shapiro (Democrat — Incumbent):** Running for a second term alongside Lieutenant Governor Austin Davis. His campaign highlights state economic development projects, increased public school funding, infrastructure modernization, bipartisan legislation, and protecting state-level abortion access.
- **Stacy Garrity (Republican — Challenger):** Pennsylvania State Treasurer and retired U.S. Army Reserve Colonel running with Lieutenant Governor nominee Jason Richey. Her platform emphasizes strict fiscal discipline, lowering corporate and income tax rates, expanding Pennsylvania's natural gas energy production, and expanding school choice programs.

- **Ken Krawchuk (Libertarian):** Third-party candidate advocating for the elimination of local property taxes, expansion of school choice, and exercise of executive veto power to curb state spending.

Key Issues

- **State Economy & Taxes:** Garrity proposes tax cuts and regulatory reductions to stimulate business growth, while Shapiro emphasizes state investments in workforce programs and infrastructure funded through current revenue reserves.
- **Energy Policy:** Divergence on expanding local natural gas production and fracking versus state incentives for clean energy transitions.
- **Education Funding:** Debate over equitable funding allocations for traditional public school districts versus state-funded school choice voucher initiatives.

Additional Candidate Information

Full candidate lists and profile guides can be reviewed via the [Spotlight PA Congressional Election Guide](#) and the [Spotlight PA Governor Election Guide](#). You can also monitor campaign tracking details on [Ballotpedia's PA-07 Race Page](#) and [Ballotpedia's PA Governor Election Page](#).